

Jonathon C. O. Mifsud

Postdoc • Laboratory of Clinical and Epidemiological Virology • Rega Institute KU Leuven ✉
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Education	The University of Sydney NSW, Australia	
	PhD, School of Medical Sciences	Jun 2021 - Apr 2025
	▪ Supervisor: Prof. Edward C. Holmes	
	▪ Co-supervisor: Dr. Erin Harvey	
	▪ Conferral Sept 2025	
	Macquarie University NSW, Australia	
	Master of Research, Biological Sciences	2021
	▪ Thesis: Explorations of the plant virosphere	
	▪ Mark: 92/100	
	▪ Supervisor: Prof. Rachael V. Gallagher	
	▪ Co-supervisor: Prof. Jemma L. Geoghegan	
	Bachelor of Advanced Science, Biology	2018
Research Experience	KU Leuven , Belgium	June 2025 - Present
	<i>Postdoctoral Researcher</i>	
	Supervisor: Prof. Philippe Lemey	
	The University of Sydney NSW, Australia	Feb 2025 - May 2025
	<i>Research Support</i>	
	Supervisor: Prof. Edward C. Holmes	
	<i>Research Assistant</i>	
	Phylagen, Inc	2021
	Hawkesbury Institute for the Environment, Western Sydney University	2021
	GenIMPACT, Macquarie University	2020
Grants and Scholarships	Plant Ecology & Conservation Lab, Macquarie University	2019-2020
	Postdoctoral Fellowship, Rega Institute	2025-present
	Australian Government Research Training Program Stipend, University of Sydney	2022-2024
	Postgraduate Research Support Scheme, University of Sydney (\$1000)	2024
	Postgraduate Research Support Scheme, University of Sydney (\$2796)	2022
	Postgraduate Research Scholarship in Virus Ecology and Evolution, University of Sydney	2021-2022
	William Macleay Microbiology Research Fund (\$1,500), Linnean Society of NSW	2020
	RTP Master of Research Stipend, Macquarie University	2019-2020

Presentations	Invited talks/seminars	
	“Mapping glycoprotein structure reveals <i>Flaviviridae</i> evolutionary history”	2024
	Virology “Wakate” Online Journal Club (virtual)	
	“Exploring the <i>Flaviviridae</i> : from virus discovery to phylogenetics and structural prediction”, University of Glasgow	2024
	“Mining RNA viruses across the plant kingdom, Verena Lighthouse”	2023
	Lightning Talk Series (virtual)	
	Contributed talks	
	“Mapping glycoprotein structure reveals <i>Flaviviridae</i> evolutionary history”, MicroSeq (virtual)	2024
	“Mapping glycoprotein structure reveals <i>Flaviviridae</i> evolutionary history”, ViBioM, Leuven Belgium	2024
	“Identification of a novel papillomavirus from a New Zealand fur seal with oral papilloma-like lesions”, MicroSeq (virtual)	2023
	“Transcriptome mining extends the host range of the <i>Flaviviridae</i> to the basal Metazoa”, Wellcome Virus Genomics and Evolution	2022
	Posters	
	Insights from small scale transcriptome mining projects in Eukaryotes The RdRp Summit (virtual)	2023
	Mining public plant transcriptomes to reveal a diverse plant virosphere Wellcome Genome Informatics Conference (virtual)	2020
	Explorations of the plant virosphere Ecological Society of Australia 60th Anniversary Conference (virtual)	2020
Honors and Awards	Microbial Genomics People’s Choice Award for Best Medium talk	2024
	Australian Virology Society Award for the Best Virology talk	2024
	Australian Society for Microbiology Award for Best Lightning Talk	2023
	Executive Dean’s Commendation for Academic Excellence in Year 2 MRES	2021
	Year 1 Biology prize for the best MRES Biology student overall	2019
	Macquarie University Merit List	2019
	300 Level Biology Prize for the best student overall	2018
Teaching and Service	Teaching	
	Peer Assisted Learning, Macquarie University	2017-2018
	BIOL 115: Genes to Organisms	
	BIOL 122: Biological Basis of Behaviour	
	Outreach	
	Big Picture, Sydney Secondary College, Balmain, NSW, Australia	2023
	Workshops	
	Macquarie University R-Users Group Committee	2020
	Hosted and presented workshops and help sessions on Introductory R topics	
	Journal Reviewing	
	PLOS One, Archives of Virology, Environmental Microbiome	
Publications	See my publications on Google Scholar	